

THE THREE 'GUIDELINES'

After over 50 years since they were coined, do Asimov's Laws of Robotics still hold true? Introduced in his short story 'Runaround' (1942), the three Laws of Robotics were impressive and logical. But are they still any good? <http://dgit.in/RoboDed>

NOTES FROM THE WRIST

For people who are incomplete without a watch. From their evolution from pockets to wrists to the author's take on smart watches, if you feel naked through the day because you took it off while taking a shower and forgot to put it on, you will relate. <http://dgit.in/WristD>

TEN TOOLS TO TRY

If you thought everybody needs a swiss army knife, you're not wrong. But if you have a list, it's going to need a revision. From the tools needed to extracting headless screws to tools that help you saw off door jams. These tools will help bring out the 'maker' in you. <http://dgit.in/TryTool>

GIFS FROM YE OLDE

Old grainy black and white photos remind us of simpler times and instill a sense of peace. These photos on the other hand will give you a bit of a surprise. They range from 'surprising' to 'shocking' in a very Monty Python-esque fashion. Take a look! <http://dgit.in/OLGif>

Does Android One have the juice it claims we can squeeze from it?

We do a battery test comparing two Android One phones that recently launched with its competitors

– By Prasad Banerjee

A lot is happening in tech this month, but perhaps nothing is as important for India as Android One. This is a program by Google in which it partners with OEMs to bring out low cost Android phones that perform much above what is expected from them. While we await more news, we have tested the performance and camera on these devices. Now we took some time to test out their batteries and pit them against some other Android competitors.

Devices used: Micromax Canvas A1 and Karbonn Sparkle V

Android competitors used: Moto E, Xiaomi Redmi 1S, Lava Iris X1, Micromax Unite 2, Xolo Q600S



Battery test: If you have followed our reviews in the past, you would know the test. For the uninitiated, we charge every device to 100%, run a 1080p video with the screen turned to full brightness and WiFi connected. We then note the drop in the battery after the video has been played for an hour.

What this means: Your smartphone screen is a battery hog. Even the smallest of screens take a lot of battery, especially when the brightness is high. So, at full brightness, your screen is consuming the most battery that it will. When a video is played on your phone, the screen is constantly turned on, which means you are consuming a lot of the battery. In general, you won't face this situation in everyday use, but a phone that can last long under such circumstances, can last longer in regular usage.

The WiFi is turned on because under regular usage, most of us generally consume the most amount of data when on WiFi. All our updates are done when we have WiFi, most of our apps are allowed to run fully, update etc. when we have WiFi. So, not only is the video running on our phone, the background apps are also given no bar and WiFi is switched on to create a more realistic situation. Finally, playing a 1080p video takes a lot of processing power, which means that the CPU is also consuming a lot of your battery.

Results

- **Micromax Canvas A1:** 18% drop
- **Karbonn Sparkle V:** 17% drop
- **Moto E:** 14% drop
- **Xiaomi Redmi 1S:** 19% drop
- **Lava Iris X1:** 26% drop
- **Xolo Q600S:** 21% drop
- **Micromax Unite 2:** 22% drop

The best we have seen in the below ₹8,000 range so far has been the Moto E, which drops 14% battery after the test. Both the Android One devices used though dropped to around 18%, as mentioned above. This means that while the Moto E would have been able to play the video for 7.1 hours, the Android One devices would have done so for just over 5.5 hours.



Inference

Overall, we were quite impressed with the battery test results of the Android One devices. The battery life is above all devices in this range except the Moto E. Though the Moto E has a 1980 mAh battery while the other Android One phones we tested have a 1700 mAh battery. They do work at par (if not better) than their competitors.

Also, the two Android One phones that we used showed better battery compared to any other in the test. At the launch event, Google had said these phones would easily go a full day and our tests seem to point towards the same. **d**